Bio Industry

Bio sector to rebound in 2Q26

We believe that domestic investor sentiment in the bio sector bottomed out in early April. It is now necessary to pay attention to key momentum factors (eg, large-scale licensing-out deals and data) for 2Q26. We present related domestic investment ideas in advance.

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Domestic bio investment sentiment to have bottomed out in early April

In 1Q26, healthcare stocks performed somewhat sluggishly (Kospi +39% vs Kospi Pharma -3%; Kosdaq +20% vs Kosdaq Pharma +2%). In particular, it was disappointing that the biotech sector, which had high expectations due to policies aimed at revitalizing the Kosdaq market, performed worse than expected. The overall sluggishness of the sector was largely influenced by reliability issues arising from Kosdaq bellwether stocks.

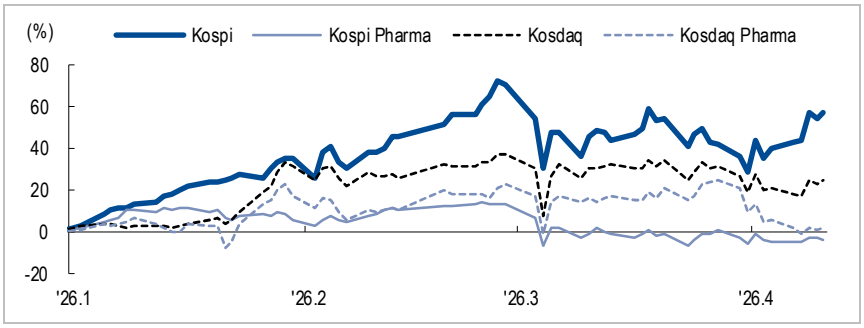
In 2Q26, however, rebound is largely expected for the sector, supported by major L/O deals (eg, LigaChem Bio, Hanmi Pharm) and momentum stemming from major conferences (eg, AACR this weekend, ASCO (abstract titles), EASL, ASCO, and ADA in May~June).

Key investment ideas from major 2Q26 conferences (AACR, EASL, ADA, and ASCO

① April: We draw attention to clinical data (ORR) from Rznomics and safety (DLT) data from HLB Innovation at the upcoming AACR conference (April 17~22), as well as pre-clinical data (AR170 as next-generation ivonescimab) from Y-Biologics. Meanwhile, Compass Therapeutics is scheduled to present data on tovecimig (value attributable to ABL Bio estimated at 40~50% of Compass's market cap).

② May: 1) EASL (May 27~30): Late-stage MASH data could be released (Hanmi-efinopegdutide, D&D-DD01); 2) ASCO (May 29~Jun 2): Abstract titles are to be released next Tuesday (LigaChem-ROR1, Yuhan-MARIPOSA). In addition, we also draw attention to TiumBio (TU2218); and 3) ADA (Jun 5~8): First survodutide phase III trial outcome for treatment of obesity is to be released; tolerability is key. Microsphere pharmaceutical companies with potential for formal contracts with Boehringer within the year, such as **G2GBio and Inventage Lab**, may come under the spotlight. Additionally, RNA-related obesity data (INHBE update rather than ALK7) is worthy of attention.

Share performance for domestic healthcare sector (2026 YTD)

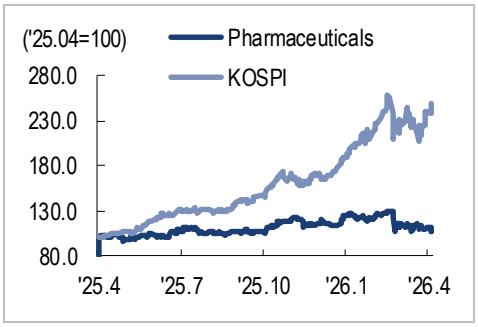


Note: Kosdaq pharmas include Alteogen and LigaChem Bio; Source: FnGuide, NH I&S Research Center

Positive (maintain)

	P/E (x)	P/B (x)
Kospi	8.2	1.7
Sector	35.1	3.4

Sector index



Sector market cap: US$113,809.01mn
(Market weighting: 3.4%)

Note: NHICS stands for NH Industry Classification Standard
※ NHICS is an industry classification system developed by the NH I&S Research Center to more precisely reflect the structure of domestic industries and the unique characteristics of the Korean stock market.

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I. Domestic bio invsetment sentiment to have bottomed out in 2Q26

1. Investment sentiment affected (Kosdaq bellwether stocks: Alteogen, Samchundang Pharm)

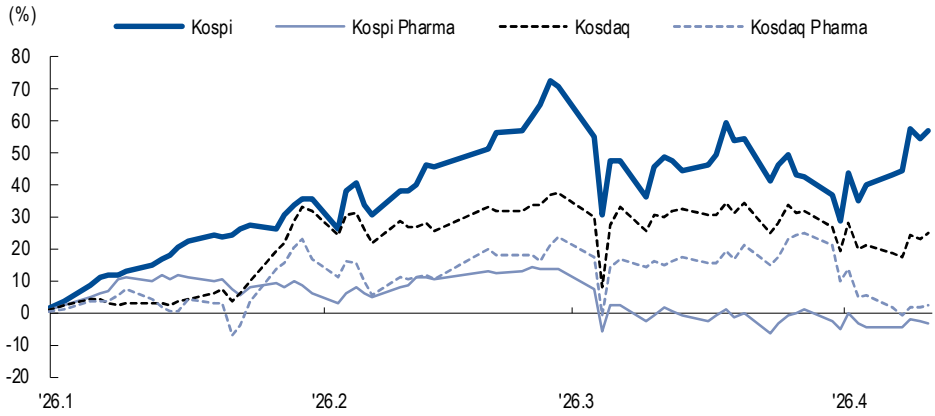
Domestic healthcare stocks performed sluggishly

In 1Q26, healthcare stocks performed somewhat sluggishly (Kospi +39% vs Kospi Pharma -3%; Kosdaq +20% vs Kosdaq Pharma +2%). In particular, it was disappointing that the biotech sector, which had high expectations due to policies aimed at revitalizing the Kosdaq market, performed worse than expected. The overall sluggishness of the sector was largely influenced by reliability issues arising from Kosdaq bellwether stocks.

A series of reliability issues have emerged at sector bellwether stocks

In the Kosdaq biotech sector, when a leading stock vacates its position, a new momentum stock frequently takes its place. For instance, after the merger and dissolution of the Kosdaq leader Celltrion Healthcare between 2020 and 2023, Alteogen took over the leading position in 2024 following the disclosure of its revised contract with MSD. Furthermore, when Alteogen's share price plummeted in early 2026 due to royalty issues, Samchundang Pharm rose to the top spot on the Kosdaq through the disclosure of its SPass contract. However, issues regarding business/clinical strategy and patents have been raised. With consecutive blows to the reliability of leading stocks in 1Q26, investor sentiment in the sector has frozen.

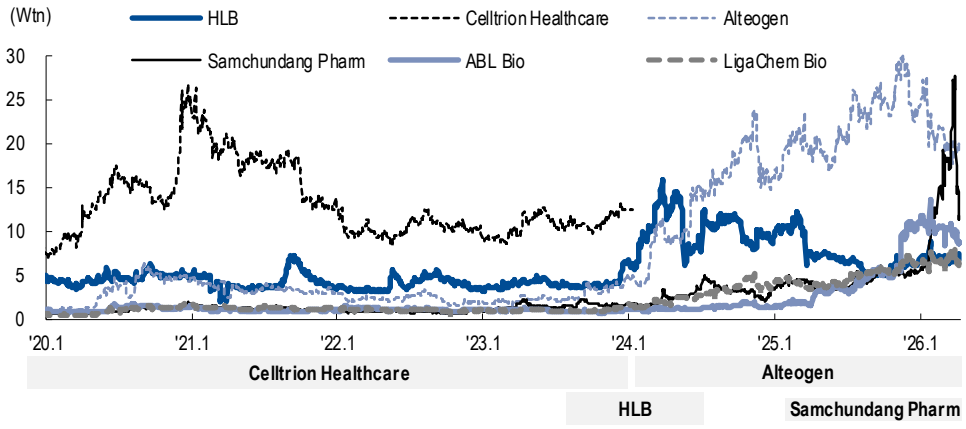
Share performance for domestic healthcare sector (2026 YTD)



Note: Kosdaq pharmas include Alteogen and LigaChem Bio
Source: FnGuide, NH I&S Research Center

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Market caps of major biotech firms on Kosdaq



Source: FnGuide, NH I&S Research Center

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2.Bio stock rebound scenarios for 2Q26

Two momentums: L/O deals and data release at conferences

Major momentums are essential for domestic bio stocks to make a rebound, and we believe large-scale L/O deals and conference data release could serve as main drivers behind the industry rebound in 2Q26. 2Q is traditionally a peak season for the pharmaceutical and bio sector, and a large-scale sector rebound is possible through the realization of the two major momentums.

Large L/O deals: Focus on LigaChem and Hanmi

Key momentum is summarized in the following table. LigaChem Bio and Hanmi Pharm are expected to sign mega-scale L/O deals worth trillions of won in 2Q26~3Q26, and other major biotechs, such as Alteogen, OliX, Qurient, ABL Bio, HK inno.N, and TiumBio, are also promising.

Major conferences to commence this weekend (AACR)

As the AACR conference begins this weekend, with multiple late-season conferences (EASL, ASCO, and ADA) scheduled for May-June, we present detailed previews of major global conference data and related investment ideas. We also list 2Q26 data presentation momentum from both domestic and global perspectives (including Eli Lilly's orforglipron prescription, Compass's ABL001, and Novartis' Pelacarsen). **As the pharma/biotech sector enters its peak season in 2Q26, we recommend staying well-informed on the table below.**

Top picks for 2Q26: Hanmi Pharm and Rznomics

We maintain Hanmi Pharm and Rznomics as our top picks for 2Q26, drawing attention to: 1) expectations for licensing-out deals for obesity drug and EASL-MASH phase II data for Hanmi and the disclosure of the first efficacy data at the AACR; and 2) RNA-based Alzheimer's disease treatment trend in 2H26 for Rznomics. For other plays with momentum as well, we see investment merit.

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Key momentum for domestic bio pharmas in 2Q26

Category	Company	Pipeline	Timeline	Importance/ *Probability	Key point
①Licensing-out (L/O) (in 2Q26~3Q26)	**LigaChem Bio**	Platform & Bio-best	-	★★★	-
	Hanmi Pharm	Obesity (TRIA, UCN2)		★★★	TRIA: Roche (late runner); UCN2: All big pharmas
	Alteogen	New L/O & Existing Milestones		★★	Including option deals for existing contracts
	OliX Pharmaceuticals	AMD / Hair loss / Obesity, etc		★★	-
	Qurient	Q901/QP101		★★	-
	ABL Bio	Grabody-B 4th deal		★★	With existing BBB big pharmas or RNA, etc.
	HK inno.N	K-CAB (Europe)		★★	Linaprazan deal reference (royalty ~20%)
	TiumBio	Merigolix		★★	Contracts to be signed with European players
②Data (conferences)	AACR	Early-stage oncology	4/17~22	★★★	**Rznomics, HLB Innovation, Y-Biologics, etc**
	EASL	Liver (MASH)	5/27~30	★★★	**D&D Pharmatech, Hanmi Pharm (TBD)**
	ASCO	Late-stage oncology	5/29~6/2	★★★	**GI Innovation, TiUM Bio, etc**
	EULAR	Rheumatology	6/3~6/6	★	-
	ADA	Diabetes / Obesity	6/5~8	★★★	**1. Survodutide obesity phase III (related domestic players include G2GBio and Inventage Lab) 2. RNA obesity data (related domestic player: OliX)**
	ENDO	Endocrinology	6/13~16	★	Lundbeck/ AprilBio (APB-A1 TED phase IIb details)
③Data (individual)	Eli Lilly	Weekly Orforglipron prescription data	April	★★★	Obesity industry sentiment recovery (esp. oral type)
	Compass	ABL001 data	April	★	**ABL Bio:** BTC 2L OS data
	Wave Life	WVE-006, ATS conference	5/15~20	★	400mg MAD → **Accelerated approval designation expected (Positive for RNA editing; domestic player Rznomics)**
	MEDIPOST	Cartistem Japan phase III	2Q26	★	-
	Novartis	Pelacarsen phase III	2Q26	★★	Domestic RNA CDMO direct beneficiary: **ST Pharm**
	Biogen	BIIB080 phase II	2Q26~3Q26	★★★	RNA Alzheimer's first phase II (MAPT) (Domestic: Rznomics RZ-001 to be highlighted)

Note: L/O probability (timing) is based on the firm's estimation and actual timing may vary
Source: NH I&S Research Center

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II. April: Biopharma sector to enter peak momentum season

1. AACR to begin this weekend

AACR 2026: Importance rising

The American Association for Cancer Research (AACR) used to be considered a pre-clinical and early-stage clinical oncology conference with relatively low significance. However, this year it is expected to be a highly important event that could lead a sector rebound depending on data results, as key domestic biotech firms are set to disclose core data. The conference is scheduled for Apr 17~22 (local time), and clinical abstract data is to be released early Saturday morning (KST).

Draw attention to Rznomics and HLB Innovation

Clinical data requiring particular attention includes that from: 1) Rznomics; and 2) HLB Innovation. Rznomics (RNA editing) and HLB Innovation (solid tumor CAR-T) are to present the first proof of concept for their respective platform technologies (proving efficacy and safety, respectively). Both are scheduled for oral presentations at the AACR—Rznomics on Apr 20 at 8:00 AM (KST) and HLB Innovation on Apr 21 at 2:00 (KST).

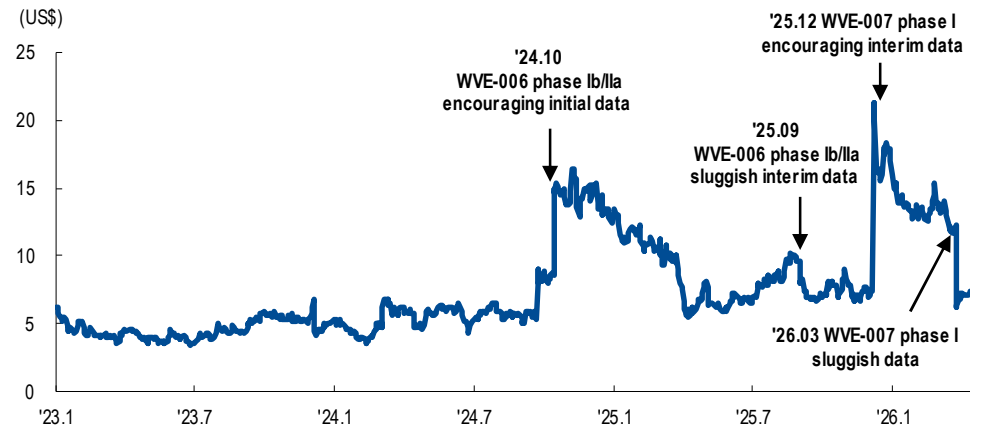
1) Rznomics: ORR to be around low/mid-30% range or higher

1) Rznomics: The core data is the ORR (efficacy) from the phase Ib/IIa triple combination study of its lead pipeline RZ-001 (hTERT) for primary liver cancer. The existing first-line SoC IMbrave150 showed a final ORR of 27% (benchmark). As this is the first ORR announcement for RZ-001, it will involve interim data (estimated to be primarily low-dose) rather than the full patient group (45 patients), making a direct comparison with IMbrave somewhat ambiguous at this stage. However, confirming an ORR in the low-to-mid 30% range or higher would be considered positive. While market expectations for ORR have recently risen, the fact that this involves low-dose cohorts must be taken into account.

2) HLB Innovation: No DLT reported

2) HLB Innovation: The first validation of the KIR platform (separating activation/inhibition signals) is expected through the SynKIR-110. Since it is a solid tumor CAR-T, toxicity is the most critical point to watch (high affinity is required for high activity in the tumor microenvironment, which increases the potential for toxicity compared to hematologic CAR-T). Attention should be paid to safety indicators, as this is the first clinical data from low-dose administration groups (Cohorts 1-3, with up to Cohort 6 planned for the future).

Share price of rival Wave Life Sciences



Source: Bloomberg, NH I&S Research Center

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3) Y-Biologics: Next x2 Keytruda

Meanwhile, among South Korean companies presenting pre-clinical data, we recommend drawing attention to Y-Biologics. While pre-clinical abstracts were pre-released on Mar 18, core data will be disclosed on the day of the poster presentation. Y-Biologics plans to present mouse data posters for: 1) AR170 (PD-1xIL-2xVEGF); and 2) AR166 (PD-1xLAG3xIL-2) on Apr 22 at 1:00 AM (KST).

Ivonescimab (next-generation Keytruda): FDA approval is key

The most important agenda in global anti-cancer drug development this year is whether the next-generation Keytruda (ivonescimab, PD-1xVEGF) receives FDA approval (HARMONi: PDUFA goal date set for Nov 14, 2026). Additionally, immature PFS data for HARMONi-3 (2Q26), immature OS for HARMONi-6 and final OS for HARMONi-2 (mid-2026), and final PFS and immature OS for HARMONi-3 (2H26) are scheduled for release throughout the year. From a data perspective, HARMONi-3 is significant, as it represents the first global head-to-head comparison data against Keytruda (corresponding to China's HARMONi-6).

Development of next-generation ivonescimab also underway

Meanwhile, China has already moved beyond next-generation Keytruda (PD-1xVEGF) and is already developing the next generation of ivonescimab (trispecific antibody: PD-1xVEGFx new target). Regarding next-generation ivonescimab, CStone's CS2009 (PD-1xVEGFxCTLA4) is being developed at the fastest pace, with phase I/II data disclosed in China last March. Safety was favorable with Grade 3 or higher TRAE of 23%, and efficacy was excellent with an ORR of 90% in 1L PD-L1 TPS >50 NSCLC (vs competitors' PD-1xVEGF in the 70% range).

AR170's early data competitiveness against ivonescimab

From the perspective of next-generation ivonescimab, we draw attention to the pre-clinical safety and efficacy data of Y-Biologics' AR170 (PD-1xIL-2xVEGF). As a trispecific antibody that also targets IL-2 (differing from CStone's CTLA4 target), competitive early data compared to ivonescimab is expected.

Major ivonescimab clinical trials at Summit Therapeutics and Akeso

Name	Region	Phase	Indication	Timeline	Others
HARMONi	Global	Phase III	NSCLC NSQ EGFRm 2L+ (ivonescimab+ chemo vs chemo)	2026.11.14 (PDUFA Date)	**FDA fast track** **Topline: PFS HR 0.52 (p<0.00001)** **OS HR 0.79 (p=0.057), satisfaction failed** **Western: OS HR (0.78, p=0.03), PFS HR 0.67 (vs Asia 0.55)**
HARMONi-3	Global	Phase III	NSCLC 1L (SQ + nonSQ) (Ivonescimab+ chemo vs Keytruda + chemo)	-	**2026: Interim data release expected (Immature PFS: 2Q26; final PFS & immature OS: 2H26)**
HARMONi-7	Global	Phase III	NSCLC PD-L1 High 1L (ivonescimab mono vs pembrlizumab mono)	Enrollment ongoing (target: 780)	**2027: Interim data release expected**
HARMONi-A	China	Approved (May 2024)	NSCLC EGFRm 2L+ (ivonescimab+ chemo vs chemo)	Final OS data updated (2025 SITC)	Approved in China (May 2024) Data: PFS 7.1 month (HR 0.46, p<0.001). OS 17.1 months (HR 0.8, 17.6 months follow-up) → OS 16.8 months (HR 0.74, p=0.019, 32.5 months follow-up)
HARMONi-2	China	Approved (May 2024)	NSCLC PD-L1+ 1L (ivonescimab mono vs pembrolizumab mono)	mOS data to be updated	**Late April: Interim OS HR 0.777 (maturity 39%)** **- statistical satisfaction failed** **Sep 2024 topline: PFS 11.14 months (HR 0.51, p<0.0001)** **PFS improved regardless of PD-L1 expression levels**
HARMONi-6	China	Phase III	NSCLC SQ 1L (ivonescimab+ chemo vs Tevimbra+ chemo)	PFS update (2025 ESMO)	**PFS HR 0.6; OS still immature**

Source: Summit Therapeutics, NH I&S Research Center

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Abstracts for AACR2026 from major domestic pharmas

Company	Candidate	Presentation type	Target	Abstract title	Schedule
Rznomics	RZ-001	CT Mini Sympo	hTERT	A P1b/2a, evaluating the safety, tolerability and efficacy of RZ-001 in combo with VGCV and atezolizumab/ bevacizumab in subjects with hepatocellular carcinoma	'04.20 08:05
HLB Innovation (Verismo)	SynKIR-110	CT Plenary	Mesothelin	Initial results of a first in human dose-escalation study of KIR-CAR in patients with advanced mesothelin-expressing solid tumors	'04.21 02:46
	SynKIR-310	Poster	CD19	Novel SynKIR-310 outperforms CD3-based 2nd gen CD28 or 41BB co-stimulated CAR T in B-cell NHL xenograft mice and shows early clinical signal	'04.22 01:00
	Other	LB Poster	EGFR	Natural killer cell-based signaling in EGFR-targeted KIR-CAR T overcomes CD3-based CAR T functional deficits to eliminate resistant glioblastomas in vivo	'04.21 01:00
HLB (Elevar)	Lirafugratinib	Poster	FGFR2	Comparative biochemical kinase activity analysis identifies lirafugratinib as a highly selective FGFR2 inhibitor	'04.20 06:00
Y-Biologics	AR170	Poster	PD-1xVEGFxIL-2v	AR170, a novel PD-1xVEGFxIL-2v tri-specific immunocytokine to redefine next generation cancer immunotherapy	'04.22 01:00
	AR166	Poster	PD-1xLAG-3xIL-2v	AR166, a first-in-class PD-1xLAG-3xIL-2v tri-specific immunocytokine delivering Cis-acting IL-2v to overcome immune checkpoint inhibitor resistance	'04.22 01:00
	Other	Poster	IL-2	Systematic discovery of attenuated IL-2 variants optimized for bispecific antibodies enabling targeted IL-2 delivery to PD-1+T cells	'04.22 01:00
Voronoi	VRN11	LBP	EGFR	VRN110755: A next-generation non-covalent EGFR tyrosine kinase inhibitor for EGFRm NSCLC	'04.22 06:00
	VRN10	LBP	HER2	Mechanistic and early clinical characterization of VRN101099	'04.22 06:00
LigaChem Biosciences	LCB14-2524/16	Poster	BCMA	Next generation ConjuAll BCMA antibody-drug conjugates (ADCs) LCB14-2524 and LCB14-2516 show increased efficacy in preclinical models of MM	'04.21 01:00
GI Innovation	GI-128	Poster	PD-L1 xLILRB	Discovery and characterization of GI-128: A PD-L1 x LILRB1/2/4 bispecific antibody as a macrophage engager	'04.22 01:00
	GI-102	Poster	CD80xIL2v3	Prediction of pharmacokinetics and pharmacodynamics profile for a fixed dosing and body weight-based dosing of GI-102 based on cell-level…	'04.23 01:00
Samsung Bioepis/IntoCell	SBE303	Poster	Nectin4	Nonclinical characterization of SBE303: A nectin-4 targeted antibody drug conjugate (ADC) with novel topoisomerase 1 inhibitor shows a favorable safety	'04.21 01:00
Orum Therapeutics	ORM-1153	Poster	CD123	ORM-1153: A novel CD123-targeting degrader antibody conjugate with proprietary GSPT1 degrading payload for the treatment of acute myeloid leukemia	'04.21 01:00
	ORM-1153	Poster	CD123	ORM-1153: A Next-Generation CD123-Targeting DAC	'04.21 01:00
Dong-A ST	PARP7 inhibitor	Poster	PARP7	A novel PARP7 inhibitor exhibits dual antitumor activity through immune activation and tumor-intrinsic growth inhibition	'04.22 01:00
	SC6313	Poster	EGFR	SC3613 (IN-207387), a mutant-selective EGFR degrader, exhibits potent anti-tumor activity and improved safety profile in EGFR TKI-resistant NSCLC	'04.22 01:00
ABL Bio	ABL206	Poster	B7-H3 xROR1	NEOK001 (ABL206): A first in class B7-H3xROR1 bispecific ADC demonstrated enhanced efficacy and promising tolerability	'04.21 01:00
	ABL209	Poster	EGFRxMUC1	NEOK002 (ABL209): Redesigning an EGFRxMUC1 bispecific TOP1i ADC with promising anti-tumor activity and enhanced therapeutic window	'04.21 01:00
J&J (Yuhan)	Lasertinib	LBP	EGFR	Impact of first-line (1L) amivantamab-lazertinib vs osimertinib on second-line (2L) progression-free survival (PFS)	'04.23 01:00
Hanmi Pharm	HM 101207	Poster	KRAS	Breaking the KRAS inhibitor induced resistance-wall: Targeting KRAS-SOS1 to disarm hypoxic survival	'04.23 06:00
	BH3120	Poster	PD-L1x4-BB	Non-clinical characteristics of BH3120, a clinical stage bispecific antibody targeting PD-L1 and 4-1BB, in combination with CD3 T cell engagers	'04.21 01:00
	BH4601	Poster	PD-L1 xB7-H3	Preclinical evaluation of BH4601, a novel tetravalent PD-L1 and B7H3 bispecific ADC with Topo1 inhibitor for the treatment of solid tumors	'04.22 06:00
Celltrion Pharm	AD2C	Poster	TROP2	A novel synergistic dual-payload TROP2 ADC (CTPH-03) delivering enhanced safety by increased MTD	'04.22 01:00
	FRα AD2C	Poster	FRα	A novel synergistic dual-payload FRα ADC (CTPH-08) that can potentially offer benefits for low IHC+ ovarian cancer patients by improving MTD and MED	'04.21 01:00

Note: Schedules based on a KST basis
Source: AACR 2026, company data, NH I&S Research Center

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2. Compass Therapeutics: To present OS and PFS data for tovecimig as second-line bile duct cancer treament

Tovecimg's OS and PFS data to be disclosed in April

In April, Compass Therapeutics is scheduled to disclose OS and PFS data from the phase II/III trial of tovecimig (ABL001) as a second-line treatment for biliary tract cancer. This is significant, as South Korea's ABL Bio is the original developer of tovecimig, and tovecimig is highly likely to become ABL's first commercialized product (expected in late 2026~2027).

Attempt to obtain approval s second-line treatment for bile duct cancer

Bile duct cancer is a cancer that occurs in the bile duct (bile duct, gallbladder, ampulla), the passage for bile. While the annual number of new patients in the US is relatively small at approximately 25,000, it is a cancer type with steady unmet needs. The biliary tract cancer market targeted by tovecimig consists of patient groups that are:1) unresectable (90%); 2) ineligible for targeted therapy (80% vs HER2, IDH1, FGFR2, BRAF, etc.); and 3) ECOG 0-1 (good systemic condition, 90%). The plan is to first obtain FDA approval as a second-line treatment, and an expansion to first-line treatment may be attempted later depending on the results of investigator-initiated 1L clinical trials at the MD Anderson Cancer Center.

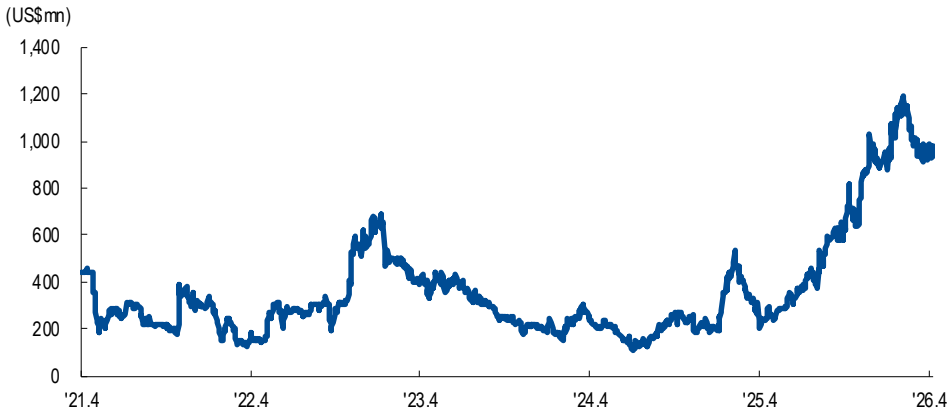
OS ORR data disclosed last year; but key is OS data

In Apr 2025, top-line data (n=111) for ABL001+Paclitaxel from the US phase II/III trial (COMPANION-002) in second-line patients ineligible for targeted therapy was disclosed (crossover for the paclitaxel monotherapy group was permitted after disease progression). The ORR was 17.1% (CR 0.9%, PR 16.2%; vs paclitaxel 5.3%, p=0.031) and the DCR was 61.2%, with safety profile remaining consistent with previous studies. That said, the OS data, which is critical for FDA drug review, is scheduled to be released in April. For reference, as the trial permitted crossover between patient groups, rank preserving structural failure time (RPSFT) adjustments will also be presented in the OS interpretation.

ABL Bio's ABL001 deserves 40~50% of Compass's market cap

The partner company, Compass Therapeutics, has a market cap of approximately W1.5tn based on its core asset tovecimig. Looking at its contract structure with ABL Bio, the remaining milestones include US$96mn for development/approval and US$300mn for commercialization (option: US$110mn if ophthalmic indications are added), with a single-digit royalty rate. For ABL Bio, the value of tovecimig can be recognized as the relative value of Compass's market capitalization. Considering the milestones and the single-digit royalty rate, reflecting around 40~50% of Compass's market cap appears to be reasonable (presenting the current value of tovecimig attributable to ABL Bio at approximately W600bn~750bn). Following the data announcement in April, the value attributable to ABL will also change according to the fluctuations in Compass's market capitalization.

Compass Therapeutics's market cap



Source: Bloomberg, NH I&S Research Center

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III. May: Investment ideas from major conferences (EASL, ASCO, ADA)

1.EASL: MASH data releases (Hanmi Pharm, D&D Pharmatech)

EASL: Hanmi and D&D

The European Association for the Study of the Liver (EASL, held in May) represents a top-tier global liver disease conference along with the American Association for the Study of the Liver (AASLD, held in November). As for this year's event, which is scheduled to be held over May 27~30, we draw attention to global MASH data release. While late-breaking abstract titles have yet to be disclosed, we predict MASH phase II data from Hanmi Pharm (partner MSD-efinopegdutide) and D&D Pharmatech (DD01) will be released.

1) Hanmi: Proving superiority over semiglutide

1) Hanmi Pharm's efinopegdutide: The efinopegdutide phase IIb study (total N=381) will disclose biopsy data at week 52, revealing MASH resolution and fibrosis improvement data for the first time. The study is designed with three drug-administered cohorts and control groups consisting of a placebo and semaglutide 2.4mg (the only global MASH clinical design to directly compare with semaglutide in phase II). The primary endpoint is the MASH resolution rate, where confirming statistical superiority in a direct comparison with the accelerated-approved semaglutide is most critical (semaglutide ESSENCE phase III: 63% at week 72, placebo-adjusted 29%). If it succeeds in proving superiority over semaglutide even in the secondary endpoint, the fibrosis improvement rate, it will be considered a definitive indicator of phase III success (semaglutide: 37% at week 72, placebo-adjusted 15%).

Furthermore, indirect comparisons can be made with the phase II results of survodutide, a leading GLP/GCG candidate. We estimate a MASH resolution rate at 30~40% and a fibrosis improvement rate at approximately 15% (both placebo-adjusted). The value of efinopegdutide attributable to Hanmi is estimated at W1tn (W1.8tn upon success; excluded upon failure).

2) D&D: Phase III entry

2) D&D Pharmatech's DD01: Out of 67 patients on week 48 biopsy, only 35 qualified as evaluable patients (F2-3) following protocol compliance (comparison with placebo). As the data size is small, securing statistical significance against the placebo group, particularly regarding fibrosis improvement, is challenging; thus, the data should be used only to identify trends. That said, even if it fails to secure statistical significance for fibrosis, if it demonstrates the potential for late-stage fibrosis improvement through additional biomarker analysis—similar to Altimmune, entering phase III should proceed without difficulty.

Global MASH treatment pipeline: Targeting GLP-1

Company	Pipeline	Stage	Target	Injection	Cut off	MASH stage	Portion of improved MASH patients	Portion of fibrosis improvement	Fatty liver reduction
Novo Nordisk	Semaglutide (2.4mg)	Accelerated approval	GLP-1	SC, QW	72wk (P3, Par1)	F2/3	**63% vs placebo group 34%, placebo-adjusted effect of 29%(P<0.001)**	**37% vs placebo group 23%), placebo-adjusted effect of 15%(P<0.001)**	-
Eli Lilly	Tirpepatide	Phase III	GLP-1/ GIP	SC, QW	52wk (P2)	F2/3	5mg 44%, 10mg 56%m 15mg 62% (vs placebo group 10%)	5mg 25%, 10mg 51%m 15mg 51% (vs placebo group 30%)	46%(5mg) 41%(10mg) 57%(15mg) placebo group (10%)
Boehringer Ingelheim/ Zealand Pharma	Survodutide	Phase III	GCG/ GLP-1	SC, QW	48wk (P2)	F1~3	**47%(2.4mg), 62%(4.8mg), 43%(6mg) (vs** placebo group **14%)**	**34%(2.4mg),36% (4.8mg), 34%(6mg) vs** placebo group **22% (p-value undisclosed)**	+ 30% improvement 63%(2.4mg), 67%(4.8mg) 57%(6.0mg) placebo group 14%
MSD/ Hanmi	**Efinopegdutide**	Phase IIb	**GLP-1/ GCG**	**SC, QW**	**24wk (P2a)**	**F2/3**	-	-	**73% (+30% improvement 82%)**
Altimmune	Pemvidutide	Phase IIb	GLP-1/ GCG	SC, QW	24wk (P2b top-line)	F2/3	* MASH resolution 59.1% (1.2mg)/ 52.1% (1.8mg) vs 19.1% (placebo group)	31.8% (1.2mg) 34.5% (1.8mg) vs 25.9% (placebo group) (missed p-value)	58.0% (1.2mg) 62.8% (1.8mg) vs 16.2% (placebo group)
D&D Pharmatech	DD01	Phase II	GLP-1/GCG	SC, QW	12wk	F1~3			**62%** (vs 8%) **76%** (vs 12%) **(improvement by over 30%)**

Source: Company data, NH I&S Research Center

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2. ASCO: The biggest global conference; abstract titles to be disclosed next week

Abstract titles for ASCO to be released next week

As the world's largest oncology conference, the ASCO annual meeting warrants significant attention as numerous late-stage clinical data sets that could redefine global standard-of-care treatments are presented. This year, it is scheduled to be held from May 29 to Jun 2. While abstract titles of the clinical trials to be presented at the ASCO meeting have yet to be released, both regular and late-breaking abstract titles are scheduled to be disclosed next Tuesday night. Offering a preview of the list of major clinical trials to be presented at ASCO, this event should deserve attention. We predict ASCO-related expectations will grow immediately after the conclusion of the AACR conference next week.

Key points of interest: LigaChem, Yuhan

Among domestic pharmaceuticals and bio firms, we draw special attention to Yuhan (MARIPOSA OS) and LigaChem Bio (ROR1 ADC). In particular, the disclosure of the finalized MARIPOSA OS values is of critical importance, as actual Lazcluze prescriptions and sales should increase in earnest only after the release of final OS data. We believe the MARIPOSA presentation is more likely at the ESMO meeting in October, but an ASCO presentation, if it actually happens, will be a significant surprise. We estimate Lazcluze royalty revenue will reach W45.5bn in 2026, based on assumptions of 10% initial royalty rate and W455bn sales (8% penetration rate in the US and 4% in the EU).

TiumBio deserves attention, among those which have already disclosed ASCO topics

Meanwhile, some domestic pharmaceuticals have already disclosed their ASCO presentation topics through the media. Among these companies, we draw attention to TiumBio's phase IIa data on TU2218 as a first-line (1L) treatment for head and neck cancer. The head and neck cancer market is valued at about US$4bn (Keytruda US$3bn, Cetuximab US$500mn, Opdivo US$500mn). Today's 1L treatments are Keytruda monotherapy or combination with chemotherapy, with mOS at approximately one year and ORR limited to the 19~36% range.

Competitors in head and neck cancer market receive high valuation

Latecomers to the head and neck cancer treatment market are developing combo therapies using Keytruda as a backbone. Leading players include: 1) Merus (phase III, petosemtamab: EGFRxLGR4); and 2) Bicara (phase III, Ficera: EGFR + TGF-B), followed by TiumBio (TU2218). Merus disclosed phase II data at last year's ASCO (PD-L1 CPS 1+, 1L ORR 63%; specifically, CPS 1–19 ORR 47%, CPS>20 73%). Later, the European big pharma Genmab acquired Merus for US$10bn (a 41% premium) to secure head and neck cancer assets. Meanwhile, Bicara's Ficera phase II ORR was 54% (CPS 1–19, consistent ORR above 20), which is inferior to Merus. Nevertheless, Bicara's market cap ranges at about W2tn.

TiumBio undervaluation could be resolved after ASCO

TiumBio disclosed initial phase IIa data for TU2218 as a treatment of head and neck cancer at SITC last November (total N=12; 1L=8, 2L=4), reporting a very high ORR of 71% (1L: 73%, 2L: 67%). We believe TiumBio's TU2218 possesses 1L Best-in-Class potential for head and neck cancer and is significantly undervalued considering the valuation of competitors (Merus acquisition price and Bicara market cap). A phase IIa update focused on 1L is scheduled at this ASCO, and if a high ORR is maintained, the results could be reflected in valuation.

Domestic pharmaceuticals' ASCO presentation

Company	Pipeline	Target	Presentation	Details
ImmuneOncia	IMC-002	CD47	Poster	Interim phase Ib data (TNBC 2L treatment, cohort, efficacy included)
TiumBio	Tosposertib	TGF-β/VEGF	Poster	Interim phase IIa data as 1L head and neck cancer treatment
Cellbion	Pocuvotide	PSMA	-	Additional Lu-177-Pocuvotide data
GI Innovation	GI-101A	CD80 x IL-2v	Oral	GI-101A, keytruda combo phase I on solid cancer
Oncocross	OC212e	-	-	Existing standard therapy+OC212e combo against pancreatic cancer

Source: Company data, NH I&S Research Center

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3.ADA: Focus on survodutide and RNA-based obesity treatments

ADA: 1) survodutide and 2) RNA-based obesity treatments

The American Diabetes Association (ADA) conference is a key venue where major obesity-related data is frequently presented. This year's event is scheduled for Jun 5~8. As some ADA abstract titles have been released, we explore investment ideas based on survodutide and RNA-based obesity treatments from a global perspective.

Survodutide obesity phase III results (first phase III outcome)

Survodutide (GLP/GCG) is a MASH/obesity pipeline under phase III trials by Boehringer Ingelheim (original developer: Zealand Pharma), with multiple phase III results expected this year. It is considered a global best-in-class candidate for MASH, while a separate phase III trial is underway to explore expansion as an obesity drug. **A search of this year's ADA abstract titles confirms that the outcome of Synchronize-1 phase III trial to evaluate survodutide for treatment of obesity will be released.** This is highly significant as it marks the first phase III results for survodutide and suggests its potential as an obesity drug beyond MASH.

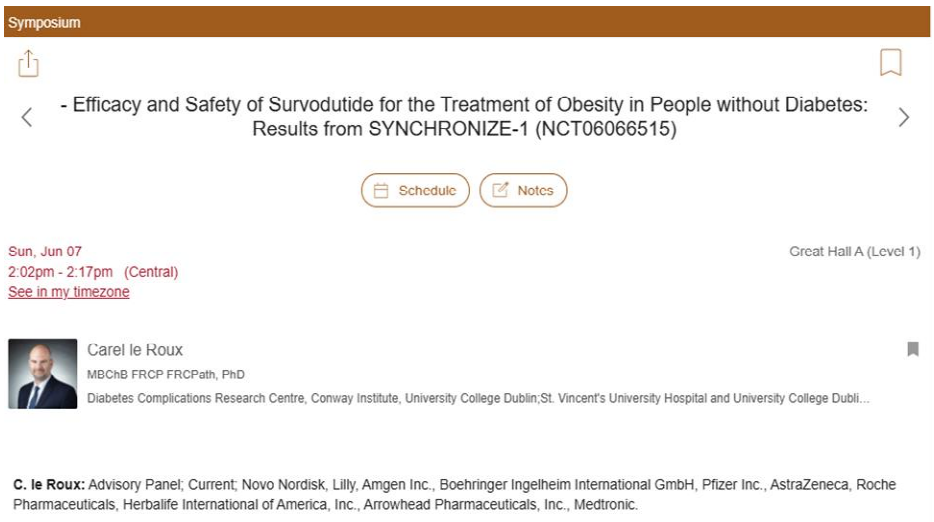
Data preview: Tolerability is key

In the previous 46-week phase II obesity trial, survodutide recorded a placebo-adjusted weight loss of 16% at the 4.8mg (highest dose) level, but tolerability issues were raised at high doses (4.8mg group: vomiting 35%, treatment discontinuation 29%, GI-related discontinuation 26%). Accordingly, the pure obesity phase III trial (Synchronize-1, 46-week) aims to improve tolerability by increasing the dose more slowly (titration) (phase II: titration every 2 weeks from 0.3mg, 0.6mg, 0.9mg up to 4.8mg vs phase III: dose escalation every 4 weeks up to a maximum of 6mg). **We foresee that the phase III data will show a weight loss improvement of around 15% (placebo-adjusted); however, the reduction in discontinuation rates due to tolerability issues should be the most critical point**.

Noteworthy domestic plays: G2GBio and Inventage Lab

In the US, peak sales for survodutide are estimated at around US$3bn~5bn (sales assumption: obesity 50%, MASH 50%). If superior data (about 15% placebo-adjusted weight loss + increased tolerability) is disclosed at the upcoming ADA, survodutide's peak sales estimate may be revised up. **In relation to survodutide, we suggest paying attention to Korea's microsphere pharmaceutical companies G2GBio and Inventage Lab**. Both companies have signed R&D agreements with Boehringer Ingelheim for monthly formulations. While the item under the agreements remains undisclosed, it is highly likely to be survodutide. As both companies aim to sign formal contracts with Boehringer Ingelheim within the year, expectations could heighten if survodutide gains prominence.

ADA 2026: Survodutide Syncrhoize-1 (phase III for obesity) data to be released



Source: ADA 2026, NH I&S Research Center

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INHBE: Doubts raised on value as monotherapy for obesity

RNA-based obesity treatments are also worthy of attention at ADA 2026. The market has focused on RNA-based obesity drug data in 1H26. In late March, Wave Life Sciences saw its stock price plunge 50% following disappointing weight loss data from WVE-007 (phase I, siRNA). Data for the low dose (240mg) at 6 months and mid dose (400mg) at 3 months were disclosed (placebo-adjusted weight loss for 240mg: 3-month -0.3% (readjusted), 6-month -0.9%; 400mg undisclosed). Given the improvement fell short of the minimum 5% total weight loss at 12 months—a benchmark set in the FDA's Jan 2025 obesity drug guidelines—doubts have been raised regarding the potential of targeting INHBE as a monotherapy for obesity (this issue is separate from ALK7).

ADA: Expectations for WVE-007 high-dose data

Wave Life Sciences is scheduled for a poster presentation on WVE-007 at ADA 2026. It is predicted to disclose 6-month mid-dose and 3-month high-dose (600mg) data. While it is difficult to expect high efficacy due to the same clinical patient profile (low BMI), **weight loss of at least 3% would be considered a data surprise**.

ADA: No additional ALK7 clinical updates expected

Meanwhile, ALK7 leader Arrowhead Pharmaceuticals previously unveiled a plan to disclose detailed early phase I data for ARO-ALK7 in 2Q26, but recently shifted the timeline to 2H26. Accordingly, no clinical data updates for ALK7 are expected at the upcoming ADA (some preclinical studies are scheduled for presentation: Suzhou Siran, etc).

RNA-based obesity treatment pipelines to be released at ADA 2026

Date	Presentation type	Company	Substance	Target	Code	Title
'06.05	Oral	Suzhou Siran	SA030	ALK7	1102	Adipose-Targeted ALK7 siRNA Synergizes with Tirzepatide to Reduce Fat Mass while Preserving Lean Mass in Diet-Induced Obese Mice
'06.05	Oral	BaseCure	BC-006	INHBE	1106	Prevention of Weight Rebound and Restoration of Muscle Mass after Semaglutide Withdrawal Using Bc-006, an INHBE siRNA, in a Nonhuman Primate Obesity Model
'06.07	Poster	BaseCure	BC-006	INHBE	1785	Safety, Tolerability, PK, PD, and Exploratory Efficacy of BC-006, an INHBE siRNA: FIH Randomized, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled, Single Dose-Escalation Study
'06.07	Poster	Wave Life	WVE-007	INHBE	1792	Interim Results from INLIGHT, a Phase 1 Study of Investigational WVE-007, an INHBE Galnac siRNA for the Treatment of Overweight and Obesity
'06.07	LB Poster	China Medical System	CMS-D008	INHBE	3079	CMS-D008 Specifically Silences INHBE mRNA, Delivering Fat-Selective Weight Loss in Preclinical Study
'06.08	Poster	WuXi AppTec	-	INHBE	2544	INHBE-siRNA as a Promising Antiobesity Therapy: Preclinical Evaluation in Diet-Induced-Obesity Humanized INHBE Mice
'06.08	Poster	Huadong Medicine	HDM 1014	INHBE	2546	Preclinical Efficacy and Safety of HDM1014, a Novel GalNAc-siRNA Targeting INHBE, for Weight Management with Muscle Preservation
'06.08	Poster	Regeneron	-	INHBE	2555	Double Knockout of INHBC and INHBE Protect against Diet-Induced Obesity and Insulin Resistance in Mice
'06.08	Poster	Innovent	IBI3046	INHBE	2662	IBI3046, an INHBE siRNA, Enables High Quality and Long-Lasting Weight Control in Preclinical Study
'06.08	Poster	Wave Life	WVE-007	INHBE	2566	Silencing Hepatokine Activin E Promotes a Healthy Body Composition and Metabolic Profile in Mice
'06.08	Poster	Biocytogen	-	ALK7	2541	Generation of Humanized ALK7 Mice for Obesity Preclinical Research and Small Nucleic Acid Drug Evaluation

Source: Company data, ADA 2026, NH I&S Research Center

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